

Thursday, 6 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

22° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

18° 13°

MANCHESTER

Heavy drizzle

18° 13°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

18° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- Shadow Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband says re-opening the Strait of Hormuz is "essential" to ease cost-of-living pressures.**

He made the comments after meeting his US counterpart in Washington. The Strait is a vital shipping route for oil and gas.

POLITICS · UK

- A shocking investigation has revealed that deworming and scabies drugs are being sold as cancer treatments.**

One terminally ill patient was reportedly offered the drugs by a stair lift salesman, who claimed they could shrink tumours. This raises serious concerns about patient exploitation.

HEALTH · UK

- An Afghan boxer has appeared in court in connection with the death of a Scottish woman.**

Sharif Ahmadzai, 26, is being held after Elisabeth Ross from Edinburgh died. The details surrounding the case are still emerging.

CRIME · UK

- After a brief drop, temperatures are set to rise again as the UK potentially faces another heatwave.**

Forecasters say any respite from the high heat and humidity will likely be short-lived. Many are concerned about the impact of prolonged hot weather.

WEATHER · UK

- The government is being urged to restrict the sale of pet flea treatments due to environmental concerns.**

The Lords environment committee says their widespread use poses potential risks to the environment. This could impact how we protect our pets.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

1 **Dog trainer and author Graeme Hall, known for 'Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly', has joined the line-up for this year's 'Strictly Come Dancing'.**

Hall has been a familiar face on screens since 2017. Fans will be eager to see how his moves compare to his canine companions.

ON AIR – What kind of dance do you think Graeme will be best at? Maybe a waltz with a dog-themed twist?

TV · AUTUMN

2 **Former rugby star Joe Marler is set to become the first celebrity 'Gladiator' when the show returns in 2027.**

He'll be known as 'Mauler' when the fourth series airs. This is a big move for the ex-England prop, taking on the iconic role.

ON AIR – Can you picture Joe Marler as a Gladiator? What other sports stars would make great Gladiators?

TV · 2027

3 **Disney has struck a deal allowing TikTok creators to use clips from its films and TV shows in their videos.**

This means more creative content could be coming to the platform. It's a significant move for both the entertainment giant and social media.

ON AIR – Which Disney movie scene would you love to see re-enacted or remixed on TikTok?

FILM · UPCOMING

4 **Ariana Grande has spoken out about the "endless, ongoing public scrutiny" over her body.**

The star has decided to take a step back from the spotlight due to the constant comments. It highlights the intense pressure celebrities face.

ON AIR – Is it fair that celebrities face such intense scrutiny over their appearance, or is it part of the job?

MUSIC · ONGOING

5 **Presenter Alex Jones has shared that she was "too scared" as a young girl to admit she wanted to be on TV.**

Growing up in Carmarthenshire, she never thought hosting a network show was possible. It's a reminder of how far she's come.

ON AIR – What was your childhood dream job, and did you ever think it was achievable?

TV · REFLECTIVE

On the schedule

1 **Ireland international Orla Prendergast took four wickets as Welsh Fire beat Manchester Super Giants in The Hundred.**

Her impressive 4-18 helped bowl out the Super Giants for just 85 runs. Welsh Fire secured a three-wicket victory, moving up the table.

ON AIR – Prendergast was on fire! What's the most incredible individual performance you've seen in a cricket match?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Mohamed Salah has been mobbed at the airport ahead of his expected move to Turkish club Trabzonspor.**

The Egypt captain and former Liverpool forward is set to be confirmed as their new signing. It marks a significant transfer in European football.

ON AIR – Salah's move is big news! Which player transfer has surprised you the most this summer?

FOOTBALL · EUROPE

3 **Tottenham boss Roberto de Zerbi hopes his "love of the transfer window" can help guide his club back up the Premier League table.**

He's been dubbed a 'transfer shark' due to his keen eye for new players. Spurs fans will be hoping for a strong season.

ON AIR – Do you think a manager's transfer strategy is more important than their coaching on the pitch?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Manchester United have appointed former Hearts boss Eva Olid as their new women's manager on a two-year deal.**

Olid has no WSL experience, but United are confident in her ability to lead the team. It's an exciting new chapter for the club.

ON AIR – What qualities do you look for in a new football manager, especially when they're stepping into a big role?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Former world heavyweight boxing champion Joseph Parker has been cleared to fight again after his provisional cocaine ban was lifted.**

Parker had tested positive for cocaine, but his suspension has now been removed. This paves the way for his return to the ring.

ON AIR – How do you feel about athletes returning to competition after a drug ban, especially in a sport like boxing?

BOXING · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that taking up a 'craft hobby' in adulthood can significantly boost mental well-being.**
Researchers found that activities like knitting, pottery, or model-making provide a sense of accomplishment and reduce stress, often more effectively than screen-based entertainment.
- 2 The enduring appeal of 'vintage postcards' is experiencing a delightful revival among collectors and casual senders alike.**
Many are rediscovering the charm of physical correspondence, finding unique designs and historical glimpses in these small pieces of art, often much to the delight of recipients.
- 3 Experts are highlighting the surprisingly calming effect of 'watching fish in an aquarium' as a form of natural stress relief.**
The gentle movements and tranquil environment of an aquatic display can lower heart rates and promote relaxation, offering a peaceful escape from daily hustle and bustle.
- 4 There's a growing trend for 'outdoor reading nooks' in gardens and balconies, creating cosy personal libraries in nature.**
People are setting up comfortable chairs, small tables, and even weather-proof bookshelves to enjoy their favourite books al fresco, embracing the fresh air and natural light.
- 5 The humble 'picnic blanket' is seeing a surge in popularity, becoming a key accessory for impromptu outdoor dining.**
With designs ranging from classic checks to vibrant patterns, these portable spreads are making it easier and more stylish for families and friends to enjoy meals in parks and countryside.
- 6 A recent report celebrates the simple joy of 'listening to local radio' for a sense of community and connection.**
Many listeners appreciate the familiar voices, local news, and community updates that local stations provide, fostering a strong bond with their area and fellow residents.
- 7 The surprising charm of 'collecting interesting pebbles' from walks is captivating people of all ages.**
Whether for their unique colours, smooth textures, or intriguing shapes, these small natural treasures are being gathered and displayed, often sparking memories of cherished outdoor adventures.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to find something we've lost, even though we know it probably doesn't help?

ANSWER: TALKING TO THE LOST ITEM, E.G., 'NOW WHERE DID YOU GO, YOU LITTLE RASCAL?'

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of coffee. What is it?

ANSWER: TAKING A DEEP, APPRECIATIVE SNIFF OF THE COFFEE AROMA BEFORE THE FIRST SIP.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'little domestic mysteries' in our homes that nobody can quite explain, don't we?**
What's that one odd thing that keeps happening in your house, or that one item that always seems to go missing and then reappear in the strangest place?

- **Think about a 'small, everyday sound' that you absolutely adore, one that just makes you feel incredibly content or happy.**
What's that particular sound – perhaps the kettle boiling, birdsong, or the distant chimes of an ice cream van – that just makes your day a little bit brighter?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know, a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know, a group of giraffes is called a 'skyscraper'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£94 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£94 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 started in a baker's shop on Pudding Lane.
- Bananarama holds the Guinness World Record for the most chart entries by an all-female group.
- The world's first public zoo, Tiergarten Schönbrunn, opened in Vienna in 1752.
- The longest river in the United Kingdom is the River Severn.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in a lifetime.
- The London Underground system began operating in 1863, making it the world's oldest underground railway.
- The first British monarch to use the title 'King of Great Britain' was Queen Anne.

On this day

Day 218 of the year, 147 days left in 2026. Today Christian holidays and observances Transfiguration of Jesus; Christian holidays and observances Anna Maria Rubatto; Christian holidays and observances Pope Hormisdas; Christian holidays and observances Justus and Pastor. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1928 — Andy Warhol, American painter, photographer and film director (died 1987)
- 1969 — Elliott Smith, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2003)
- 1981 — Leslie Odom Jr., American actor and singer
- 1940 — Louise Sorel, American actress
- 1932 — Michael Deeley, English screenwriter and producer
- 1987 — Leanne Crichton, Scottish footballer
- 1951 — Catherine Hicks, American actress
- 1930 — Abbey Lincoln, American singer-songwriter and actress (died 2010)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1914 — World War I: U-boat campaign: Two days after the United Kingdom had declared war on Germany over the German invasion of Belgium, ten German U-boats leave their base in Heligoland to attack Royal Navy warships in the North Sea.
- 2008 — A military junta led by Mohamed Ould Abdel Aziz stages a coup d'état in Mauritania, overthrowing president Sidi Ould Cheikh Abdallahi.
- 1997 — Korean Air Flight 801 crashed at Nimitz Hill, Guam, killing 229 of the 254 people on board.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1965 — US President Lyndon B. Johnson signs the Voting Rights Act of 1965 into law.
- 1958 — Law of Permanent Defense of Democracy, outlawing the Communist Party of Chile and banning 26,650 persons from the electoral lists, is repealed in Chile.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1926 — Gertrude Ederle becomes the first woman to swim across the English Channel.
- 1915 — World War I: Battle of Sari Bair: The Allies mount a diversionary attack timed to coincide with a major Allied landing of reinforcements at Suvla Bay.

- 1960 — Cuban Revolution: Cuba nationalizes American and foreign-owned property in the nation.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 219 of the year, 146 days left in 2026. Today Assyrian Martyrs Day (Assyrian community); Battle of Boyacá Day (Colombia); Christian feast day: Afra; Christian feast day: Albert of Trapani. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — John Glover, American actor
- 1974 — Chico Benymon, American actor
- 1969 — Paul Lambert, Scottish footballer and manager
- 1955 — Wayne Knight, American actor, comedian and voice actor
- 1961 — Brian Conley, English actor and singer
- 1975 — Charlize Theron, South African actress
- 1937 — Don Wilson, English cricketer and coach (died 2012)
- 1966 — Kristin Hersh, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2008 — The start of the Russo-Georgian War over the territory of South Ossetia.
- 1962 — Canadian-born American pharmacologist Frances Oldham Kelsey is awarded the U.S. President's Award for Distinguished Federal Civilian Service for her refusal to authorize thalidomide.
- 1995 — The Chilean government declares state of emergency in the southern half of the country in response to an event of intense, cold, wind, rain and snowfall known as the White Earthquake.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1960 — Ivory Coast becomes independent from France.
- 2020 — Air India Express Flight 1344 overshoots the runway at Calicut International Airport in the Malappuram district of Kerala, India, and crashes, killing 21 of the 190 people on board.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)